

Incident Report 0031. TLP CLEAR.			Date	Breakout Scale
Title	UK, EU, U.S: - The International Far-Right's Impact on the UK Southport Riots		15/10/2024	6

Summary

- Non-domestic far-right groups played a significant role in inflaming tensions across the UK following the Southport murders.
- The social media activity led to offline demonstrations.
- These accounts, some of which hide their identities, posted unrelated content from other incidents to spur people to take to the streets.
- Long-term and systematic monitoring of extremist groups and foreign states could help mitigate future crises.

Incident

From July 29th to the 31st, the initial three days of the Southport Riots, non-domestic far-right groups played a significant role in inflaming tensions following the Southport murders.

Of the top 20 Telegram channels spreading content about the riots, only six were based in the U.K., with others originating from the U.S., Europe, and beyond. These international actors repurposed the local incident to insert broader far-right narratives, such as anti-immigrant sentiment and conspiracy theories like the "Great Replacement."

On X, four out of the five most-shared posts surrounding Southport during the initial three days were authored by accounts outside of the U.K. Key international influencers, such as U.S. accounts associated with groups like QAnon and "White Lives Matter," repackaged local news to spread disinformation.

The content rapidly spread to 36 countries across 6 continents within the first ten minutes, with U.S.-based accounts accounting for 36.5% of impressions. Posts from non-domestic actors generated millions of impressions, with much of the inflammatory content remaining live despite its misleading nature.

Narrative

N/A

Impact

Reach: The 5 most interacted-with posts had over 7 million views in total.
The social media activity led to real-life violence.

Key Objectives and Behaviours (DISARM Red Framework)

Objective: [Encourage](#) – Encourage people to participate in the riots.

[Deceptively Labelled or Translated](#) – The far-right accounts posted unrelated content from old incidents to stoke divisions.

[Use Pseudonyms](#) – Accounts involved used pseudonyms to hide their real identity.

Recommendations

- Action taken: Report sent to UK and EU policy-makers and regulators to raise awareness.
- Systematic long-term monitoring of extremist groups and foreign states should be funded by governments and set up by civil society, allowing us to quickly respond and potentially mitigate similar crises in the future.

Report	Topic	Evidence	Authors	Content type	Platforms
Link	Southport riots, far-right.	Upon request	Al Baker, Prose Intelligence. Ned Mendez, 411 Julian Neylan, A4E Saman Nazari, A4E	Video, image, text.	X, Telegram.